

MISSIONS

Before you can wage war in a game of Warhammer 40,000, you must first select a mission. The Core Rules include a single mission – Only War – that is ideal to get the action started quickly. Others can be found elsewhere in this or other books, or you could play a mission of your own creation. If you and your opponent can't agree which mission to play, you must roll off, and the winner decides.

1

MUSTER ARMIES

Players muster their armies based on their selected battle size, as described on pages 55-56. Each mission will guide players on what size of battle they can play, and may include further rules that could affect how players pick their armies.

2

READ MISSION OBJECTIVES

Each mission will state what its primary objectives are, and may also include one or more special rules. These cover unique situations, or abilities that can be used in the battle.

3

CREATE THE BATTLEFIELD

Each mission will include details of the size of the battlefield that you will need. Each mission will also instruct you if any terrain features or objective markers must be set up, and will provide details of where to set them up. Otherwise, it is assumed you are using the guidelines on pages 49-52 to create your battlefield. If you are using a battlefield that is a different size or shape to those guidelines, you will need to adjust distances, and the location of deployment zones, objective markers and terrain features, in an appropriate way.

4

DETERMINE ATTACKER AND DEFENDER

Players roll off and the winner is the Attacker – their opponent is the Defender.

5

DECLARE BATTLE FORMATIONS

In the order stated below, both players now secretly note down:

- Which of their Leader units will start the battle attached (they must specify which Leader unit is attached to which Bodyguard unit).
- Which of their units will start the battle embarked within **TRANSPORT** models (they must specify which units are embarked within which models).
- Which of their units will start the battle in Reserves (including Strategic Reserves).

When both players have done so, they declare their selections to their opponent.

6

DEPLOY ARMIES

Each mission includes a deployment map that shows where each player can set up the models in their army (called their deployment zone), and will list any restrictions that apply to setting up.

7

DETERMINE FIRST TURN

Each mission will tell you how to determine which player has the first turn.

8

RESOLVE PRE-BATTLE RULES

Players alternate resolving any pre-battle rules units from their armies have, starting with the player who will take the first turn.

9

BEGIN THE BATTLE

The first battle round begins. Players continue to complete battle rounds until the battle ends.

10

END THE BATTLE

Each mission will tell you when the battle ends. This will typically be after a set number of battle rounds have been completed, or when one player has achieved a certain victory condition.

11

DETERMINE VICTOR

Each mission will tell you what you need to do in order to win the game. If neither player manages to achieve a victory then the game is considered to be a draw.

OBJECTIVE MARKERS

Objective markers represent objects of tactical or strategic import that both sides are attempting to secure, such as valuable artefacts, vital supplies or communications nodes. If a mission uses objective markers, it will state where they are located on the battlefield. These can be represented using any suitable marker, but we recommend using round markers that are 40mm in diameter.

When setting objective markers up on the battlefield, place them so they are centred on the point specified by the mission. When measuring distances to and from objective markers, measure to and from the closest part of them. Models can move over objective markers as if they were not there, but they cannot end a move on top of an objective marker.

At the start of the battle, each objective marker on the battlefield is said to be contested, and so is not controlled by either player. To control an objective marker, a player will first need to move models within range of it. A model is within range of an objective marker if it is within 3" horizontally and 5" vertically of that objective marker.

Every model has an Objective Control (OC) characteristic listed on its datasheet. To determine a player's Level of Control over an objective marker, add together the OC characteristics of all the models from that player's army that are within range of that objective marker. A player will control an objective marker at the end of any phase if their Level of Control over it is greater than their opponent's. If both players have the same Level of Control over an objective marker, that objective marker is contested.

- A model is within range of an objective marker if within 3" horizontally and 5" vertically.
- **Level of Control:** Add together the OC characteristics of all of a player's models within range of the objective marker.
- An objective marker is controlled by the player with the highest Level of Control over it (in a tie, it is contested).
- Models cannot end a move on top of an objective marker.

Hints and Tips OBJECTIVE MARKERS AND TERRAIN FEATURES

Many players choose to bring the narrative of their missions to life by positioning objective markers within exciting terrain features on the battlefield. When setting up terrain features, you can place them where an objective marker would be, so long as you can reposition that objective marker directly on top of that terrain feature and it lies flat, without overhanging any part of it. That objective marker should still be more than 1" away from all impassable parts of that terrain feature (such as the walls of a ruin) so that there is sufficient room for models to move around it.

If it is not possible to set up terrain features or objective markers in this way, and both players agree, you can nudge the positions of any terrain feature or objective marker so that these conditions are satisfied. Of course, the final position of an objective marker should still be as close as possible to the location indicated on your mission's deployment map, but if both players are happy to tweak the battlefield arrangement to forge a stronger narrative, you should feel free to do so.

MISSION MAP KEY



Attacker's Deployment Zone
The Attacker must set up their army within this area.



Defender's Deployment Zone
The Defender must set up their army within this area.



No Man's Land
The region of the battlefield that is not within either player's deployment zone is known as No Man's Land.



Objective Markers
The locations of objective markers on the battlefield are typically shown on the deployment map of the mission being played, and are represented by this icon.



Attacker's Battlefield Edge



Defender's Battlefield Edge



Centre of Battlefield

ONLY WAR

MISSION

The time has come to prove your worth as the greatest commander in the galaxy! All that stands between you and ultimate glory is an opposing force bent upon your destruction. Destroy the enemy army and secure strategic sites littered across the battlefield while stopping your foe from doing likewise.

1 MUSTER ARMIES

First, players will need to muster armies based on the battle size they have selected, as described on pages 55-56. This mission is designed for Incursion, Strike Force and Onslaught battle sizes.

2 MISSION OBJECTIVES

CAPTURE AND CONTROL

Progressive Objective

Starting from the second battle round, at the end of each player's Command phase, the player whose turn it is scores 1 Victory point (VP) for each objective marker they control (to a maximum of 3VP per turn). Details of how to control objective markers can be found on page 58.

3 CREATE THE BATTLEFIELD

Players now create the battlefield and set up terrain features using the guidelines on pages 49-52. The minimum size of your battlefield depends on the battle size you have selected, as shown in the table below.

BATTLEFIELDS

BATTLE SIZE	MINIMUM BATTLEFIELD SIZE
Incursion/Strike Force	44" x 60"
Onslaught	44" x 90"

Players must then alternate setting up objective markers on the battlefield, starting with whichever player wins a roll-off, until a total of four have been placed. Objective markers cannot be placed within 6" of any battlefield edge, or within 9" of any other objective markers.

4 DETERMINE ATTACKER AND DEFENDER

Players roll off and the winner is the Attacker – their opponent is the Defender.

5 DECLARE BATTLE FORMATIONS

In the order stated below, both players now secretly note down:

- Which of their Leader units will start the battle attached (they must specify which Leader unit is attached to which Bodyguard unit).
- Which of their units will start the battle embarked within **TRANSPORT** models (they must specify which units are embarked within which models).
- Which of their units will start the battle in Reserves (including Strategic Reserves).

When both players have done so, they declare their selections to their opponent.



6 DEPLOY ARMIES

Players then alternate deploying their units, one at a time, starting with the Attacker. Models must be set up wholly within their controlling player's deployment zone. Continue setting up units until both players have set up all the units from their armies, or you have run out of room to set up more units. If one player has finished setting up their army, their opponent continues to set up the remaining units from their army.

If both players have units with abilities that allow them to be set up after both armies have deployed, the players must roll off after all other units have been set up and alternate setting up those units, starting with the winner.

7 DETERMINE FIRST TURN

Players should roll off again, and the winner takes the first turn.

8 RESOLVE PRE-BATTLE RULES

Players now resolve any pre-battle rules their armies have.

9 BEGIN THE BATTLE

The first battle round begins. Players continue to resolve battle rounds until the battle ends.

10 END THE BATTLE

The battle ends when all of the models in one player's army have been destroyed, or once the fifth battle round has ended (whichever comes first).

11 DETERMINE VICTOR

If, at the end of the battle, one army has been destroyed, the player commanding the opposing army is the victor. Otherwise, the player with the most Victory points is the victor (in the case of a tie, the battle is a draw).

